

2.7 The Basics Of Filters

From smoothening or sharpening images to adding an artist's touch, filters offer a myriad of options for corrections and after-effects. We will be discussing filters in depth in our chapter on Advanced Effects, but here, we give you an introduction to some of the more common filters you will use.

Technically speaking, a filter is a device or even a rule or logic that is used to remove unwanted parts of data (in this context, “data” refers to image data). In modern audio or image editing software however, filters do more than just remove certain parts of data. They also apply transformation—that is, they change existing characteristics apart from simply removing certain characteristics. Thus a filter performs calculations on the image based on a certain pre-defined logic and also user input in certain cases, in order to produce a variation of the original image.

There is virtually no limit to the ways images can be altered, but Photoshop offers a range of filters to perform the most commonly sought-after effects. For example, you can make an image appear as if it is seen through glass, painted on mosaic tiles, add brush strokes, and so on.

There are about 90 filters organised under different sub-menus in the Filter menu. Of these, you can use the Blur and Sharpen filters to make corrections to the image. Most of the other filters are like after-effects or artistic effects which you can use if you are trying to remove details from the image, but retain the overall *feel* of



The Filters pull-down menu